

S03-04 - Firstmoss Launch Festival

Player read-aloud

Firstmoss banners flutter overhead, some official, some clearly painted over by children with better taste.

Scene summary

Optional festival flavor shows Hush's culture and resilience.

Visible choices

- Arm wrestle
- Paint stones
- Shop for trinkets
- Taste moss fruit

Player questions

- What detail in Firstmoss Launch Festival tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

GM notes

- Cut this for a 2?3 hour table unless players need a breather.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- [REFLAVOR/GUARANTEED] Firstmoss and the Sunless Farms show the forest feeding Hush rather than hunting it.

Checks and rolls

- Presence or Knowledge Learn what the ward protects by joining the celebration. Easy Make Act Five emotionally legible. 10 Cleanly resolve: Learn what the ward protects by joining the celebration. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Firstmoss Launch Festival. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to make trust cost time, reveal a local fear, or show a ward symptom that locals have normalized. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Festival route The ward matters. Corporate metrics undercount communal life. The ward protects gathering places, not abstract assets.
- Guaranteed seed Firstmoss and the Sunless Farms show the forest feeding Hush rather than hunting it. Firstmoss and the Sunless Farms show the forest feeding Hush rather than hunting it.

Loot

- Festival charm
- Clover cake
- Name of someone Tamsin cared about

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act Three pressure: Optional festival flavor shows Hush's culture and resilience.
- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s03-04-join-the-festival-contest S03-04 Join the festival contest Join the festival contest Strength Finesse Strength Finesse 12 Strength joins the work; Finesse joins the craft. The PCs watch community instead of participating in it. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The PCs watch community instead of participating in it. Use a hard...
- Gm Fear Spends: Make trust cost time, humility, or a public apology. Show a ward symptom locals have normalized because nobody official listened.
- Conditions Hazards: No official condition unless a feature, hazard, or fictional position calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable.
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability, or someone vulnerable in danger.
- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence, or a concrete concession.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: Firstmoss Launch Festival asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Finesse, Instinct, Presence, Strength. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength,

Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.

- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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